Saket Saurav

Principal Cloud Engineer | Cloud & AI Architecture | Multi-Cloud & OKE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Distinguished Principal Cloud Engineer with 12+ years of enterprise IT engineering excellence, including 6.5+ years of deep specialization in Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI) and Multi-Cloud architectures (Azure, AWS, GCP). Proven architectural track record designing, migrating, and operating mission-critical, telecom-grade cloud estates and regulated air-gapped environments for global enterprises. Specialized in modular Infrastructure as Code (Terraform) driving ~60% reduction in deployment lifecycle and eliminating configuration drift, mission-critical on-prem to OCI cloud migrations (ExaCS, Autonomous DB, and Oracle RAC high availability).

Recognized for bridging strategic enterprise architecture, cloud-native scalability, zero-trust security, and AI-powered operational autonomy. Hands-on leader with extensive delivery across private OKE cluster topologies, modular Terraform IaC automation, GenAI CloudOps dashboards, and enterprise database modernization (Exadata, Autonomous Database). Accomplished in directing cross-functional engineering teams, authoring technical decision records (TDRs), and establishing organizational landing zone governance.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Databases & Mission-Critical Data:** Oracle Database 19c/12c/11g, Oracle RAC (Real Application Clusters), Exadata Database Service (ExaCS), Autonomous Data Warehouse (ADW), Autonomous DB (ADB), Data Guard, RMAN Backup & Recovery
- **Enterprise Cloud Architecture:** Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI - Primary), Multi-Cloud (Azure, AWS, GCP), Landing Zones, VCN Hub-and-Spoke, DRG, FastConnect, Private DNS, Network Firewalls (Palo Alto VM-Series), High Availability & DR Topology
- **AI & GenAI Platform Engineering:** LangChain, LangGraph, Local LLMs, Model Context Protocol (MCP) Servers, Agentic AI Frameworks, RAG Architecture, GenAI CloudOps Dashboard, Offline ChatOps CLI, ODAOS (Autonomous DB Ops)
- **Infrastructure as Code & DevOps:** Terraform (Reusable Modular Blueprints), Ansible, OCI Resource Manager, OCI CLI, Bash Scripting, OCI DevOps, Git, GitHub Actions, Automated CI/CD Pipelines, Multi-Environment Release Governance
- **Container & Cloud-Native Platforms:** Kubernetes (OKE), Docker, Helm, Private OKE Clusters, FSS Persistent Storage (StorageClass, PV, PVC), Layered Security & RBAC, Application Load Balancers (ALB/NLB), API Gateway Ingress
- **Zero Trust Security & Identity:** OCI IAM Identity Domains, Azure Active Directory / Microsoft Entra ID Federation, SAML 2.0 / SSO, SCIM Provisioning, Okta Integration, Linux PAM Hardening, OCI IAM Database Environment Isolation, Confidential Applications
- **Observability, SRE & Governance:** Prometheus, Grafana, Splunk, Datadog, OCI Logging Analytics, Service Connector Hub, ONS Alerting, Multi-Cloud Cost Governance (Cloudability), Capacity Planning & Performance Tuning

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Cloud Engineer (OCI) / Manager-Projects • Cognizant (Client: KPN (Netherlands)) *2024-11 – 2026-07 (1.7 yrs)*

- **Cloud Architecture & Landing Zones:** Owned the architecture of a production-grade, air-gapped Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI) environment for telecom billing platforms (DBSS Revenue Management / BRM modernization), defining landing zone, network domains, connectivity model, and isolation boundaries.
- **Cloud Architecture & Governance:** Produced architecture design documents, technical decision records (TDRs), and operational runbooks covering network topology, platform dependencies, environment patterns, and support procedures, improving implementation clarity and governance traceability.
- **Network & Trust Architecture:** Defined segmentation and trust architecture across OKE, database, storage, bastion, and shared services tiers, establishing private DNS and service discovery across hub-and-spoke VCNs using delegated zones and environment-specific namespace separation.
- **Kubernetes (OKE) Engineering:** Provisioned and managed production private OKE clusters enforcing layered security, blast-radius containment, and network policies, resolving complex OKE operational issues and reducing platform incidents by ~40%.
- **Stateful Storage & Ingress:** Engineered OCI FSS-backed persistent storage (StorageClass, PV, PVC) for stateful telecom billing workloads; configured ALB/NLBs and API Gateways with DNS-based routing and enterprise TLS for secure, scalable external ingress.
- **Cluster Security & RBAC:** Implemented Kubernetes-native RBAC and authentication model in the absence of external identity providers, achieving secure multi-tenant access control entirely within cluster boundaries.
- **Infrastructure as Code:** Automated end-to-end OCI infrastructure provisioning using modular Terraform (networking, compute, OKE clusters, FSS storage), reducing deployment time by ~60% and eliminating configuration drift across environments.
- **Governance & CI/CD:** Developed robust OCI CLI / Bash automation for bulk resource tagging and compliance governance across hundreds of OCI resources; engineered CI/CD pipelines integrating OCI DevOps for automated deployments.
- **AI-Driven Operations (GenAI CloudOps):** Architected and delivered a GenAI-powered CloudOps Dashboard integrating OCI Monitoring, cost analysis, security insights, and automated remediation workflows, pioneering AI-driven operations for KPN's cloud estate.
- **Air-Gapped ChatOps & Local LLMs:** Developed an offline ChatOps CLI using LangChain and local LLMs for secure AI-assisted diagnostics in air-gapped OCI environments, enabling intelligent incident triaging without internet dependency.
- **Autonomous DB Operations (ODAOS):** Spearheaded ODAOS (Oracle Database Autonomous Operations System) implementation, automating complex database operations and reducing manual DBA intervention by ~50%.
- **Model Context Protocol (MCP) & AI Tooling:** Modernized API integrations by migrating legacy frameworks to next-generation AI models via Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers, leveraging Cursor IDE for accelerated cloud development.
- **Security, IAM & Zero Trust:** Designed and executed a successful POC for OCI IAM Database Environment Isolation, hardening non-production environments and establishing a blueprint adopted for production rollout.
- **Enterprise Federation & SAML:** Implemented federated identity integration between OCI and KPN enterprise IAM (Azure Active Directory) using SAML-based SSO; automated OS-level PAM configuration to enforce strict access controls; designed confidential application patterns in OCI IAM.
- **Leadership & Stakeholder Mentorship:** Mentored and supervised junior cloud engineers, setting structured growth goals; collaborated directly with cross-functional stakeholders (identity, network, security, PMO) to align cloud architecture with business requirements.

OCI Cloud Administrator • Emerson (EITS) *2018-06 – 2024-11 (6.5 yrs)*

- **Enterprise Cloud Migration:** Defined and executed cloud migration strategy from on-premises to OCI (ExaCS and IaaS), architecting VCNs, DRGs, Palo Alto VM-Series Firewalls, and IPSec VPN for secure hybrid connectivity supporting Emerson's global business.
- **Hub-and-Spoke Networking:** Architected hub-and-spoke OCI network topology with NLBs, Application LBs, Network Firewalls, and cross-region/cross-tenancy connectivity solutions supporting enterprise workload migration.
- **Enterprise IAM Governance:** Implemented enterprise IAM governance integrating Okta and Azure AD with OCI Identity Domain for SSO and SCIM provisioning, enforcing strict least-privilege control policies.
- **Core Infrastructure Provisioning:** Led provisioning, configuration, and capacity scaling of OCI services: Compute, ExaDB, ADW, OAC, Linux VMs, Object Storage, and Block Volumes based on business demands.
- **Centralized Logging & Observability:** Implemented centralized logging architecture using OCI Logging Service and Splunk; integrated Datadog, Cloudability, and Infoblox for multi-cloud observability and cost governance across OCI and GCP.
- **IaC Automation:** Utilized Terraform and OCI Resource Manager for Infrastructure-as-Code deployments, driving infrastructure repeatability and eliminating manual provisioning overhead.
- **Disaster Recovery & SRE:** Developed and maintained DR runbooks, network architecture diagrams, and OCI configuration documentation, ensuring operational readiness, high availability, and knowledge continuity.
- **Performance & Capacity Tuning:** Monitored OCI environments using Prometheus and Grafana, performing proactive capacity planning and performance tuning to optimize resource utilization and cloud cost efficiency.
- **Database Administration:** Administered Oracle DB 19c/12c, RAC, and Exadata (on-premise and cloud), managing high-availability backup/recovery (RMAN), Data Guard, patching, cloning, and production upgrades.

Oracle DBA / BI Administrator • ITC Infotech *2016-11 – 2018-06 (1.7 yrs)*

- **Database Administration:** Administered Oracle Database 12c/11g production environments, managing proactive performance tuning, RMAN backup & recovery, patching, and cloning for enterprise mission-critical systems.
- **BI & Data Integration:** Supported Oracle Business Intelligence (OBIEE) and Oracle Data Integrator (ODI) platforms, including deployment, configuration, pipeline orchestration, and troubleshooting.
- **Middleware Administration:** Managed Oracle WebLogic Server administration for middleware hosting of BI and enterprise analytics applications.

Oracle DBA / BI Administrator • Tech Mahindra *2014-01 – 2016-10 (2.7 yrs)*

- **Production DBA & RAC:** Delivered comprehensive Oracle DBA services for production and DR environments, including Oracle RAC administration, Data Guard configuration, performance tuning, and space management.
- **Analytics & Data Pipelines:** Supported Oracle Analytics Server (OAS/OBIEE) deployments and managed large-scale data migration workflows using DB links, Export/Import, and ODI pipelines.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Architect Professional** – Oracle (2026)
- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure DevOps Professional** – Oracle (2026)
- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Generative AI Professional** – Oracle (2026)
- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Certified Architect Associate** – Oracle (2026)
- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Certified Generative AI Architect** – Oracle (2026)
- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Certified Autonomous Database Architect** – Oracle (2026)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech) in Electronics & Communication Engineering • Suresh Gyan Vihar University, Jaipur (70%)